

Focus groups

What this tool produces · *A peer-validated mapping of local challenges, a clear ranking of site priorities, and a documented understanding of internal community disagreements.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Focus groups*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Creating a safe bubble of political intimacy where personal struggles are transformed into recognized, legitimate collective demands.

Evidence we produce

A peer-validated mapping of local challenges, a clear ranking of site priorities, and a documented understanding of internal community disagreements.

Duration & Material

Duration · 1 half-day to 1 full day per group

Material · Flip-charts, markers, audio recorder, printed maps

Reference case

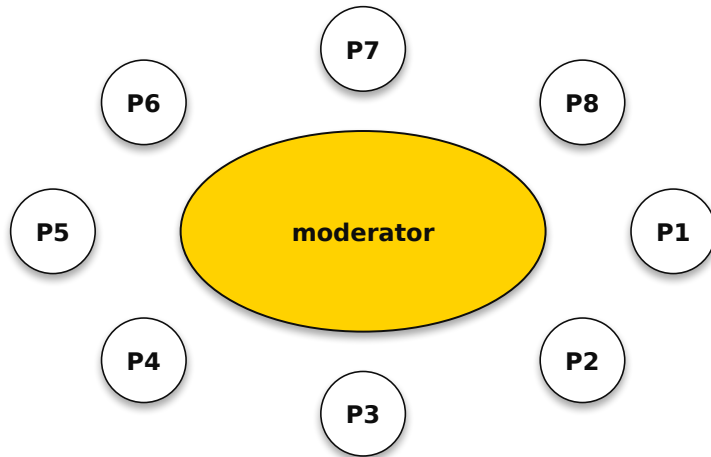
During the UN-Habitat Planning Law Assessment Framework, intensive focus groups of 5 to 10 subject matter specialists met to debate, evaluate, and formulate direct proposals to improve local planning legislation. The participants discussed spatial dimensions in detail and provided a consensual, motivated ranking backed by evidence.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Roundtable discussion → consensus

Duration
1 half-day to 1 full day per group

The table · 6 to 10 voices



Participant profiles

*e.g., local business owners, young residents,
subject-matter specialists*

Warm-up

Open the room with one shared experience

Dive

Explore the topic · divergent ideas

Debate

Where do we disagree? Why?

Synthesis

What do we agree on? What stays open?

SWOT synthesis

Strengths

Weaknesses

Opportunities

Threats

Let participants debate with each other · not just answer the moderator. Validate the synthesis collectively.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.